

The Root Tantra of the Assembly of Wrathful Mantras, the Vajra

Vajramantrabhīruśāntimāratāntra Nāma · Toh 843 · Derge Kangyur

དབྱ་སྒྲུ་འདུ་པ་རྩོལ་མཁའ་རྒྱ།

The Root Tantra of the Assembly of Wrathful Mantras, the Vajra, known in Sanskrit as the Vajramantra Bhirusanti Mara Tantra Nāma and in Tibetan as Drak ngak düpa dorje tsawé gyü, is a tantra of the Nyingma tradition that opens with the Blessed One, the Great Vajra Holder, dwelling atop Mount Meru in a splendid palace. In union with the Great Mother, sovereign lady of the five elements, he sends out rays of light that stir the malevolent and arrogant beings of the world-systems, setting the stage for teachings on wrathful mantra practice. The text carries a colophon-style framing in which the master Padma, that is Padmasambhava, is said to have given this counsel to his disciple Langpel Gyi Senge. It is Toh 843 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the tantra section and, more specifically, to the collection of tantras transmitted in the Nyingma lineage.

Thus the master Padma spoke and gave this counsel to his disciple Langpel Gyi Senge.

In the language of India: Vajramantra Bhirusanti Mara Tantra Nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Root Tantra of the Assembly of Wrathful Mantras, the Vajra. Homage to the Blessed One, the Lord of Power and Might.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One, the Great Vajra Holder himself, dwelt on the summit of the great Mount Meru, in the supreme place of willow leaves, in a great and splendidly adorned palace. There he entered into a state of non-dual equipoise with the Great Mother, the Sovereign Lady of the five elements. From his body he emitted rays of light of many kinds, which shook and stirred every place in the world-systems where there were the malevolent, the arrogant, the splendid, and the fierce.

Moved as if by the force of the wind, these beings came rushing in, together with their chieftains, their retinues, and their servants. They were these: the Great Black Yama, Lord of Life, together with his consort; the Great Black Māra with his breath of fire, together with his consort, the Black Demoness Dripping Blood; the King of the Rākṣasas, the Black Slayer, together with his consort; the great yakṣa Pūrṇabhadra, together with his consort, the flesh-eating yakṣiṇī Single Braid; the king of the gods, the Great Lord Īśvara; the lord of the

rudras, the Black Liberator; the mighty Mu king, the great monarch; Kāla the Black, lord of the gods of the outer paths; the great Viṣṇu, the All-Pervading; the youthful and fierce lord of the nāgas; the great Licchavi king of the gods; the great yakṣa Hand-Wanderer; the great Self, the Beautiful Vajra; and the great nāga-māra, Red Yamśud. Besides these there gathered, in inconceivable numbers, gods, nāgas, asuras, flesh-eaters, hungry ghosts, hosts of elemental spirits, and terrifying hosts of messengers.

Then the Blessed One, knowing how to subdue this retinue of the great evildoers, manifested the maṇḍala of a great charnel ground.

The spheres of the sky, appearing as forms, were utterly terrifying.

The sounds were harsh, fierce, and savage.

The smells were foul, rotting, and putrid.

The tastes were sour and burning, and they sickened.

The touch was hot and rough, the conduct cruel.

The fire of great hatred blazed,

pride packed the cliffs with skeletons,

delusion spread a thick darkness,

and the great rivers of blood of desire roared.

The wind of jealousy surged wildly.

In the great charnel's pleasures

tigers, leopards, beasts of prey, jackals, and wolves,

and flocks of vultures, crows, and winged creatures

devoured flesh, drank blood, and crushed bones.

There were corpses, rotting and putrid flesh,

sand, and what was crumbled and shattered,

what was eaten, scattered, and strewn about,

what was torn, oozing, and ruined,

and there was quarreling, laughter, and mockery.

Terrifying, malevolent, and ferocious,

they manifested the playful pleasures of the place.

All of them bore minds of malice,

and in deeds of the body, killing, cutting, and chopping,

they cried out in harsh and violent voices.

By the fierce ascetic conduct of wrath

they subdued and destroyed all without remainder,

and were wholly set upon wrathful suppression.

Though it was seen and appeared in this way,

it appeared only at the conventional level,
and not the slightest harm was done
even to a single hair of a single sentient being.
They move at ease in their own conceptions.
This is the very reality that is certain.

This is the first chapter, the introductory chapter, which shows the great miracle.

Then all the buddhas,
by the king who holds the vajra,
by the victors of the three times together with their spiritual sons,
from time without beginning,
in order to confer empowerment upon the great Lord of Secrets,
the protector of the teaching without exception,
the yakṣa Vajrapāṇi, holder of the vajra,
together with his five hundred companions,

From before the great chief of the Pratyekas,
he rose up from his own seat
and wrought a manifestation of wrathful conduct.
From the seed syllable abiding in his heart,
all the ten directions, to the very limits of space,
were violently stirred by a dark green wind.
An ocean of blood churned and trembled,
and from the ground, packed with flesh and bones,
the fire of the aeon, Mount Meru ablaze, blazed forth.
A blazing palace of bhandha,
fierce and terrifying,
which even the mightiest cannot approach,
the body that fulfills all activity without remainder
pervades the outer, the inner, the edge and the center.

For those who hate the teaching,
he spread out their aggregates as a footstool.
With the three pure seats of light
he made the supreme and great body,
and pressing down upon the summit the edge-dwelling knowledge-holders,
eighteen thousand pure appearances shone forth.

With his hands he slew the eight arrogant gods.
In right and left hands he held bhandha and citta.
With the first sign of the power of his mind he seized them.
Unchanging in compassion, dark blue in color,
his feet pressed down upon the fearless knowledge-holders,
subduing the four māras together with their directions.
In order to draw all beings without exception under his power,
his dark tawny hair blazes at the peak of existence.
With blazing eyes he gazes upon the three realms.
With flared nostrils he inhales the three existences.
The wind-sound of his nostrils fills the thousandfold world.
With sharp, glorious fangs he liberates the cruel.
His coiled tongue strikes the palate with a fierce sound.
By the light of his wrathful brow he draws all under his power.
He is richly adorned with heroic attire.
In his body the guardian deities are complete.

The mistress of the great elements,
who pleases that mighty one,
has three heads, six arms, and four feet.
In her right hands are the curved knife, the trident, and nectar;
in her left are bhandha, the great field, and the prosperity vessel.
The chief lord, assuming the guise, is most elegant.
From the play that brings delight,
manifestations that subdue stream forth.
In all the world-realms of the ten directions,
all the lords of wrathful mantras,
who bear the fierce and cruel aspect,
together with their own retinues,
appeared each one in their dwellings and supports,
bowing and trembling, without any freedom.

Om vajra sarva duṣṭānām ekaya mama bhera bhagṛhṇa hūṃ phaṭ.

Māras and Yamas and rākṣasas,
yakṣas, gods, and holders of wrong views,
the great Mu-rje and those of the outer direction,
those who work cruelty and travel in the sky,
animals, those who move crawling, and those who hold bodies,

the arrogant and the magical emanators,
all who roam the borderlands and frontier abodes,
the dwellings of gods, māras, humans, and non-humans,
in the snowy lands, scattered and burned,
their karmic bodily powers drawn out,
all of them without exception,
as if stirred by a violent wind,
trembled greatly and stood before him.

Though the Lord of Compassion regarded them,
with the body of the great, fierce, terrifying one,
with the sound of his voice speaking fierce secret words,
he commanded them, to their complete satisfaction:

"E ma! You lords of fierce mantras of all world-realms,
you arrogant ones,
without transgressing the command of the former great vajra-holders
and of myself,
you, together with your retinues,
quickly show in this terrifying place
your several bodies and imputed names,
your families, supports, and deeds,
your hosts, your guise, and your enjoyments.
If you transgress this,
by the pledge of my life,
your body, mind, and life
shall be destroyed forever without remainder."

Having spoken thus, he also spoke these assemblies of fierce mantras:

Om sarva duṣṭāntaka hana daha paca hūṃ phaṭ.
Yama rāja mṛtagasya mama kṣetra mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Duḥprag rāja dugdunma tiṃ mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Rakṣa ragmo mama rati ka mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Yakṣa apasmāra rakṣa miruśampa mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Mahādeva īśvara rāja mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Mātaṅga rudra kāla mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Mun mun paca citta mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Tīrthika mate mahādeva mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Biṣṭu pitra rokṭi ja mārāya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.

Nāgarāja kumāra caṇḍa māraya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Rājā bhūlonga esa yamāraya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Mahā khulo sabho māraya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Vajra sādhu. So aṃ ca māraya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Abhiśūtraṃ li māraya hriṃ hriṃ jaḥ jaḥ.
Nṛ hur thumsa jaḥ. Śatruṃ māraya rbad.

Having uttered these words, the wrathful, blazing body of the Blessed One once more displayed itself in a terrifying form. All the world-realms of the great trichiliocosm, the buddha-fields of all the buddhas, were filled with a great and dreadful sound, with light and blazing lightning, and with the fierce force of wind. The arrogant ones of the ten directions, such as the māras and the Lords of Death, together with their own retinues, gathered completely. Laying down the pride of their respective classes, they came near into the very presence of the Blessed One and strove diligently to carry out his command.

This is the second chapter, "Gathering Under Power through Great Blessing," from the Root Tantra of the Gathering of Wrathful Mantras.

Then, before the Blessed One, there came swiftly the king of the māras of that world-realm, named Fire-Breath. He was black in color, with fire blazing from his mouth, holding a club and a black noose of the māras in his hands, and clad in a garment of field-hide. With him came his consort, the dark demoness named Dripping Blood, holding a club and a fresh skull-cup, wearing a garment of human skin. Both rode a black māra horse, bear and lion at once, and they arrived together with the host of gods of the family of māras.

In the same way came the Lord of Death, called Yama. Black in color, he held a skull and a curved knife. His consort, Yama's Devourer, held a curved knife and a skull in her hands. The two, clad in damp field-hide, rode a water buffalo, and together with their host of male and female Yamas, they hastened swiftly, threatening those who oppose.

The flesh-eating rākṣasas also came, father and mother, black in color and clad in field-hide. In the right hand they held a sword and a curved knife, and in the left a human head and a blood-filled skull. Riding tigers and lions, they roamed, and with their host of rākṣasas they swiftly took their places.

The yakṣa Pūrṇabhadra, together with his consort, the flesh-eater with a single braid, were dark blue, and they rode fast horses. Clad in field-hide, they held in their two hands a sword, black silk, and field-hide, and with their host of

yakṣas they took their places.

These are the commanders of the lords of wrathful mantras. In the places of the east, south, west, and north, they bow to their chief and take their seats.

The one called the Great Lord (Maheśvara), by the mantras of the worldly gods, was white, holding a banner and a crystal knife, clothed in white silk, and riding a sky-ram. With his arrogant retinue of god-māras, he came swiftly and took his seat in the eastern direction.

The one called Black Liberator was black in color, holding offering cakes and a poison vessel. Riding a black bear and clad in field-hide, he took his seat in the southern direction with his host.

The one called Black Rmuje held black silk and a noose. Wearing a black felt cloak and riding a rmu horse, he took his seat in the western direction with his own host.

The great black tīrthika also held a khaṭvāṅga and a trident. Clad in human skin and riding a buffalo, he took his seat in the north with his own host.

The one called Viṣṇu, or Rokti, was dark blue, holding a club and a weapon. Clothed in black clouds and riding a blue dragon, he took his seat in the upper direction together with the planetary māras and their retinue.

The nāga king called Without Life-Force wore black clothing and a garment of snakeskin, and held a vase and a tortoise. Riding a water-monster, together with his host of nāgas, he took his seat in the lower direction.

In addition there were the nine-armed Libi, Thesé the chief, and Yamshu, the lords of their respective mantras. They were white, yellow, and red in color, holding crystal knives, with their nine arms spread out. They held long red silk spears in their hands, and, riding white horses, vultures, goat-born steeds, and red horses, they were clad in field-hide.

Each with their own hosts and attendants, they took their seats, abiding at the four gates of the directions.

In addition there were gods, nāgas, and yakṣas, the mamo goddesses, the Lords of Death, the rākṣasas, and the māras; the Rudras, the non-Buddhists, the gongpo and thé spirits, the ging and mu spirits, the planets, and the gyendren and men spirits; the proud gods and demons of the visible and the existent world; and the retinues of the great chieftains of the hunt. They were the outer, the inner, the secret, the very secret, and the wrathful ones; the

binders and the clingers, the wounders; the workers of deeds, the butchers, and the Thorshong; the Chedrak, the Tsal, and the mamō; the Duntip, the Tongtrug, and the life-takers; the Lenzhing, the mighty ones, and others besides.

In accordance with the command of the Blessed One, the Vajra-Holder, and in obedience to it, they displayed their own powers at the unobstructed great charnel ground, with trembling and swift force, and they stood listening to his command, praising his words, and following after him.

Seated in this way, those proud lords of the worldly realm, endowed with the power of mantra, displayed before the Blessed One the distinctions of their retinues, their classes, their might, and their enjoyments, and then spoke these words: Blessed One, great Vajra-Holder, we who dwell in the realms of the world are a malevolent host, wicked and hateful. We are filled with thoughts of harming, of violence, of livelihood and quarrel, and we are unable to give rise to loving-kindness, compassion, or a mind of benefit. We therefore request that you declare to us teachings that accord with our own realms, functions, classes, deeds, supports, powers, and distinctions of authority, teachings that are fierce and endowed with strength.

This is the third chapter, "The Arrangement of the Maṇḍala of the Assembly," from the Root Tantra of the Gathering of Wrathful Mantras.

Then the Vajra-Holder, displaying the greatness of his body and urging them on with the essence of his speech, made the intention of his mind his chief concern, and spoke to the assembled retinue of the proud and powerful ones of the world:

Hūṃ! Great hosts of the proud ones of the world, listen and act according to my command.

I am the dharmakāya, great bliss, spontaneously accomplished from the beginning, uncontrived. In the body of appearance there is no real thing. It is the body of wisdom, the supreme of bodies.

I am the great power of mantra speech, free from the sounds of conventional expression from the beginning. There is no clinging to spoken words. It is unceasing speech, the glory of speech.

I am the supreme mind of truth, free from any sign from the beginning, perfectly without it. Non-dual, the mind is without effort. It is unborn mind, the glory of mind.

I am the great gathering of qualities, spontaneously accomplished and beyond thought. Without aspiration, every need arises, the basis from which great accomplishments are produced.

I am the source of enlightened activity, whose very nature is complete diligence. Pacifying, enriching, empowering, and wrathful, the many kinds of benefit for others are spontaneously fulfilled.

You too, proud mantra lords of the world, great chiefs and masters, are in no way different, in mind and wisdom, from me and the buddhas of the three times. You are not distinct from them in speech, and in body you are not to be regarded separately. Your qualities are fulfilled in equality, and your activity is one, accomplishing what is held in common.

From beginningless time until now, through the cause and effect of affliction and karma, you have ripened into aggregates that take on a bad rebirth. Your bodies, speech, and minds, puffed up with pride and arrogance, possess immeasurable strength and power. Though you have become endowed with greatness, ferocity, and sovereignty, you have not realized the meaning of the genuinely definitive. You have not grasped ultimate truth, your minds do not incline toward the virtue free of elaboration, you have not found the power of the Victor, self-awareness, the play of the unborn expanse has not dawned for you, you have not gained the confidence of the abode of great bliss, you are not intoxicated by the taste of the signless essence, you have not seen the form of the body of the nature of reality, and you only half-meditate on the crude surface of wisdom.

Therefore, sons of good family, realize fully your own abiding nature. Do not cling to the body as a self that truly exists.

Do not speak of it in words, and do not conceive of it in the mind as a real thing. Place, region, family, lineage, troop and army, the supports, the substances, the enjoyments, and one's share of power: none of these is to be grasped as "I" or "mine." Whether common or separate, or one, all of these are utterly empty, and emptiness itself is just these. Apart from this there is nothing else, and apart from other things, this too does not exist. It is unborn and unceasing, without defining mark. It has not been wiped clean, nor added to, nor corrupted, nor fabricated, nor altered, nor has it come into being. It is unborn, not accomplished, and not explained. That great meaning arises from oneself alone. Outer, inner, before, after, above, below, the directions and intermediate directions, saṃsāra and nirvāṇa, body and mind: in none of these

is it found, and it does not exist even in this. In flesh, blood, skin, and bone, in the heart, the lungs, and the other organs, in the sense faculties and the limbs, that sublime great bliss does not dwell. Nor does it dwell anywhere apart from these. What has no established dwelling is spoken of as dwelling. If you hold that it has a dwelling, realize it there. What is it like? What is it? How is it? From where has it come, and to where has it gone? Where does it sit, and what does it do? Realize fully its shape, color, name, and mark, and its family and element. Looking at it with this very thing, there is no seeing, and that is the looking. By whom is meditation done, on what, and where? That which is free of meditation is called meditation. Who acts in general, and with what? Acting without abiding in any of the nine modes of conduct is great conduct. From whom, by whom, is it attained, and what is accomplished? The unaccomplished, self-abiding is the result. The complete perfection of all qualities, without remainder and in every aspect, is sovereign power. Pacifying, enriching, subjugating, and bringing under one's power are the enlightened activities. It is perfect in itself and accomplished by itself. Decisive certainty, instruction, the authoritative, the ultimate, repetition, the passed beyond and the not passed beyond, the teacher, explaining, listening, and compiling, and the place, time, qualities, and faults: all these are accomplished through realizing one's own suchness.

Thus he spoke.

This is the fourth chapter, the chapter that closely teaches the place of ultimate truth, from the Root Tantra, the Assembly of Wrathful Mantras.

Then the Vajra-Holder spoke these words of great import.

The heart of the meaning, the nature of reality, never arisen and unborn, is realized as meaning free of the extremes of subject and object. The Rudra who is puffed up and tormenting through the conceptual thought that grasps at "I" and self, if not liberated, is a fault. Skillful means, wisdom, and compassion, these three, in harmony and complete accord, are what the sons use to liberate him. Without realizing that ultimate meaning, those who act as though things were real fall into saṃsāra. When one acts with skill and realization, the noble ones are pleased and sentient beings are freed. The accumulations are completed and the three bodies are attained. Having seen the awareness of all, one reaches certainty. One begins the practice with fierce ascetic discipline, for the sake of bringing beings under one's power and taming them. The tantra gathering the activities of the world was taught by me and by the

Teachers. In the charnel ground, the self-abiding dharmadhātu, the vidyādharas compile it for the sake of the Buddha's teaching. In the age of the degenerate times, a Dharma that depends on praise and establishment will appear in the guise of faults and qualities. Once those of evil deeds who destroy the teaching have been liberated by the power of wrathful mantra, one will come to attain perfect buddhahood. The maṇḍala is the support of those who dwell in it. Deities, mantras, and meditative absorptions, and the substances, become causes and conditions. The liṅga and the target are the supports of visualization. The name, bones, and "enlightenment-essence" are supports of the consciousness, and of the life-force and vitality that wander in saṃsāra. By summoning and drawing in, these are summoned. Messengers accomplish all actions. One increases the glory of mantras and substances, intoxicates with the substances for the rites of union, and paralyzes, strikes dumb, hurls weapons, and reduces to dust. One strikes at the vital point and draws out from the heart. One separates from the deity and cuts the root. The substance of the awakening mind is a drop of the essence of blood at the crown. The all-base, the size of a sesame seed, abides there. It resembles the root, the dwelling of the wind, like a peg or a fire-frog.

By gathering, burning, and cutting, the object of focus is made to be parted from its support. Its radiance and splendor are absorbed into oneself. For the one who is to be subdued through the four kinds of action, virtue and sin are equal in their essential nature. Those endowed with the view and the conduct take the field, purify it, and liberate it into the supreme realm beyond.

As for the consciousness in the intermediate state, through the outpouring and gathering back of Hūṃ and Phaṭ, one performs the actions of purifying and of transferring upward. One generates it as a child of the Victors of the ten directions. The mere remaining aggregates are thoroughly purified by means of the three supports. One shows the reflected image of the truth body. By this, one engages in the vast conduct of the supreme, unsurpassed emanations, the buddhas of the three times, and the bodhisattvas, the children of the Victors.

Thus the Blessed One declared. This is the fifth chapter, on the focusing of the meditative absorption of liberation, from the Root Tantra, the Assembly of Wrathful Mantras.

Then the Vajra Holder spoke this classification of rites. First, for this, there is the auspicious place: a charnel ground, an island in a lake, or the slope of a

mountain, a place fierce and savage. There the practitioner who keeps the sacred bond, deeply learned and steadfast, a disciple fully accomplished, having first pleased the lama, possessing the strength of his personal deity, the Vajra Holder Heruka, being no different from one who is close to him, becomes one who has attained the proper measure. Having seen the signs of certain and genuine confirmation, he should apply himself with great effort.

At the site of maturation and fierce, auspicious ground, for those who are appointed to the rite, one prepares the support for focusing on the haughty ones, the chief and his retinue, in the proper measure, such as a fathom in size. From the center the spokes of the wheel are set, four, six, or eight in number. The intervening spaces are open toward the four directions, with four gates, and the wheel is adorned with garlands of skulls in three tiers. For the mantra practitioner, according to his own family, shape, color, ornaments, and signs, all of these are to be made complete.

For the haughty ones, the supports of the body are drawn, carved, or built, and set beautifully in their own places. The essence of speech is likewise. The supports of mind are their respective implements, or substances accumulated beforehand. The wheel of one's own mantra that has been accumulated, the corresponding forms, and the banners of life-force are drawn within as symbolic supports. Into each of these, the essence of the focus is compressed and placed within the citta. They become hidden and concealed supports.

In the northeast direction of that, in accordance with the tantra I explained before, one digs a pit, a cubit or a span deep, in the shape of the letter E, with four or eighty-two sides, and smears it with fierce and savage substances. Burning with fierceness is also done by this. The substances for setting it up are these: a cord-less ugly form, a skull cup, the wood of the lion tree and the golden tree, and limbs that have grown. They also include the glorious fierce phurba, black glass, black thunder, white giling, red-faced one, the unique moon, the srid tree, carakas, the pleasant-throated, and the bodies of land-dwellers and water-dwellers. These are adorned with the outer, inner, intermediate, and secret. The substances that please all in the great burning offering include beautiful forms, the sound of drums and flutes, the great fragrance of incense, flesh, blood, and taste, hot and rough touch, the essence of grains, and food offerings. The assembly of great flesh, sacred substances, and nectars is to be arranged with care and combined with diligence.

A hero, bold and dauntless, in accordance with my own earlier rites, pacifies the wrathful with wrath. Finally, he meditates on the five great elements that abide as fierce mantra elements. Visualize a mountain of blazing skeletons, or a fearsome charnel-ground mansion without measure, built from the three kinds of bhandha. It is filled with a mass of new and old tira. Red rakta streams down, and great fat swirls as smoke and billows. The sense organs, hearts, and essences dangle and writhe. Nectar, feces, and urine give off their stench. Limbs, hands, and feet are spread and strewn about. Skins and hides are stretched and flutter. In the four directions, the intermediate points, above and below, they hang down, contracted and extended, with banners and rag-garlands.

Banners and streamers flutter, with ritual daggers, folded cloths, and curtains, packed with kakamala, adorned with exquisitely beautiful ornaments. Such a blazing celestial mansion is taught as supreme in this mantra tradition. The lord of the arrogant, together with his consort, joins in union, and through that very purpose the nature of oneself is fully generated. Distinguish the radiating forth and the array of implements; in gathering back, rest in one's own abode. Through the characteristic and essential nature of whatever has taken form, and through the activity of the awakening mind, the one with his consort is brought to completion. As before, his activity too is carried out by the Victor on his own support for the hands. Visualize his retinue, swift in arrival, the māras, the Lords of Death, the rākṣasas, the fierce yakṣas, the nāgas and the gods, each with their own wives, as terrifying, just as I have described.

Those who abide at the four gates, the gods, the mātṛs, the kings, the gings, the btsan and 'gong spirits, the rmu, the non-Buddhists, together with their own hosts and armies, the entire assembly of the arrogant, whatever has been spoken of in this teaching, make clearly manifest in that very form. Confer empowerment of the family of wisdom upon my body, speech, and mind; bless, and seal them, and absorb into them the one who abides in his own nature. Accomplish the teaching through the perfect body. Prostrate, make offerings, and praise, and greatly please the deities, outwardly, inwardly, and secretly.

Gathering, joining, and liberating; abiding, lengthening, and sequence; generating and bringing down; the pleasing of the deities, by the spontaneously present, uncontrived abiding nature, practice the wrathful mantra's play without obstruction. What is applied to one's own rites is as follows: the māra's blow and the Lord of Death's belly, the rākṣasa's red and

the yakṣa's sorcery, the god's punishment and the mātr's plague, the planet's cry and the nāga's poison, the cutting short of life and the closing of the pit, the beast's grin and the iron lock's fastening, illness, weapon-wounds, and possession, drinking poison, and a thunderbolt's falling, so fierce that there is no such thing as release. The māra attacks the life unexamined. The Lord of Death cuts with the wheel of saṃsāra. The rākṣasa shatters with the teeth of a sword. The yakṣa destroys with a thunderbolt of sky-iron. The god pierces with the spear of desire. The mātr's stab like countless arrows. The planet-māras strike with mighty hail. The nāga, from beneath the earth, with swords and the like. This is the mantra that subdues and severs all.

The darkness-stirring cry of the māras, the Lord of Death like a wailing, the corpse-raising ghouls rivaled by the rākṣasa, the fierce knotted tongue of the yakṣa. The god's curse decrees a fierce edict; the mātr's lament is grieving; the planet-māra is the roar of dragon thunder and lightning; the nāga destroys with the black serpent's poison. The worldly gods and rākṣasas, by their own sound, lay curses on ordinary beings. This is the curse of the wrathful mantra. Thus he spoke.

This is the sixth chapter, on the approach rite of cursing, from the Root Tantra, the Assembly of Wrathful Mantras.

Then Vajradhāra taught the individual wrathful-mantra curses. The wrathful mantra of the māra who shatters the aggregates: in a skull of black rabs beer, offer black crystal to the heart. Cast over it a net of black cloth from the charnel ground. Bind it with five-colored threads or with black thread. Insert an iron knife and a pointed implement into the life-vein. Gather white mustard, black mustard, black sesame, skye-tshe, shang-tshe, cumin, powders of copper, iron, and stone, together with poison, blood, and ngar, into the skull of a mu-su-ra. Dispatch the māra's life-force mark with mantra.

Bdud po nag po kha mun de ba mi la cho. Ka la mu tri mā ra ya. Dgra bo snying ling tsitta rbud. Nri bzlum khyigs. Bram bram ro la 'dus. Zer sprugs. Ro sprugs. Bdud rjes chod. Bdud mos rol. Bdud bus gtor. Bhrūṃ khyigs. Pra ma ni. Śatruṃ mā ra ya rbad.

The one called Darkness-Stirring is the māra's own speech of the future. Always recite it and scatter it upon the pointed implement. Whoever is the target, swiftly may the māra of appearance and existence draw out his life.

Black men with their weapons, black mantras, women, Mon and stones; black dogs, black horses, black birds, black vultures, black mules, black crystals;

black mountains, black lakes, gatherings of black crystal; armies, turmoil and battle, abduction, killing, and slaughter of flesh animals: these become the signs that the rite has succeeded.

Then strike and bind the target's effigy, and cut it up with a knife and a ritual dagger. Mix the remainder with nectar, flesh, and blood, and give it as food to the black Kuku. Do not use it for play. Perform the rite again and again, until the enemy, drunk with poison and gasping, dies.

Now the wrathful mantra of the Lord of Death, Yama. Take a skull cup, male and female, and join it at the mouth to a ritual cake. Place the target's very mind inside. Pierce it from the top of the male skull through to the crown. Binding, covering, and drawing out the life: perform all of these, sprinkling and striking with the substances described earlier.

Yama me-takṣe. Ra-tsa sa-to me. Ru-tsa na-yo ni. Ro-ma tsa-ni. Sama rāja. Mu-ka, heart, blood, strike with power, phaṭ. Yama, seize the breath. Ro-tsa Yama Rāja. Rāja, the pill, phaṭ. Yama Rāja hrī, cut off above the heart. Yama, heart. Yama, blood. Yama du, the pill, phaṭ.

This is the mantra that gathers and rolls up Yama. Praise it highly, and strike the mind with it. Satisfy the lord with great flesh and blood. By the host of black killers, the heart and its essence are given up moist, and the heart and skull are made to leap.

Then, if you apply the rite to its work, whoever is the target is swiftly liberated. Now the curse of the fierce, wrathful rākṣasa. Place within the skull of one swiftly dead, inside the heart, the likenesses of the targets, bearing name and mantra, sought out and prepared. Wrap it in a cloth of the colors of aged silk, and put it in a net of blue and red thread. Open the mouth of a fresh stomach, and release the heart essence of the senses within it. Satisfy the rākṣasa and recite the curse.

Rākṣasa, lord of rākṣasas, sa-mun-ja. Rākṣasa Rudra hūr hūr bhyo. Black Ru-gñan, upon the enemy bhyo. Enemy, mu-le, be torn apart, tear! Hab-le hob-le, upon the speaker bhyo. Rākṣasa ja. Tri-ta ja. Du-ru du-ru shan ja. Rākṣasa phaṭ. Nṛ mārāya, tear!

Recite the curse over the substances and strike. By the host of black butchers, abduction, killing, and the heart's essence are granted. Apply the rite as prescribed, and the enemy's life-essence is swiftly released.

Now the wrathful mantra of the yakṣa. The heart and skull of a white horse are praised as the vessel into which the effigy is placed. Pierce it with the great rākṣasa device. Honor it by offering a heart portion and a blood portion together. Speak the life-essence curse of the yakṣa.

Yakṣa ba-hu-da-ri ja. Ma-ga-la bag-sha ja. Ru-ru ma-ru-tra ma-ti ja. Yakṣa, upon the heart, shad shad du ja. Yakṣa, upon the life, bred thum ja.

When the name appears, gatherings, lights, and sounds, red winds, and swirling dust will come. Strike fiercely with the secret substance. Burn the remainder and scatter it to the wind. Vomit that very thing into blood, and so release the target.

Now the wrathful mantra of the fierce, powerful god. Within the heart of a white yak of the gods, draw the divined likeness, with the name and bones. Tie it by the neck with blue and red thread. Place it inside a skull of noble lineage. Seal the mouth with white silk, and bind it with five-colored thread. Insert the quill of a vulture's feather into the life-channel, and pierce it at the center.

Make the maṇḍala an arrow's length, square, with a downward-pointing triangle at its center. Upon the three-stone hearth of the gods, place the skull described above. Prepare the harmonious substances, a clean offering cake, hunters' portions, a white deer's heart, a white crystal heart, a white bird's heart, a horn weapon, and a white banner as the support. The mantra-empowered arrow rite with white mustard seed should be set among the substances of the rite. Sprinkle the wrathful mantra within the heart.

The powerful Vajra-holder, vividly visualized, links the mantras in which the gods are gathered.

Mahā-deva ti-ja ti-ja. Sama phrama na rākṣasa kaṃ-ka-la-ya hūṃ. Deva Rāja Mahā ni-ja. Enemy, mārāya, thun phaṭ, thun phaṭ.

Shak sen ja ja. Shak sen ja ja hūṃ hūṃ. Catur-mukha rākṣasa mana. Kaṃ-ka-ma-ya hūṃ. Mahā-deva amuka mārāya soḍ.

The one famed throughout the world, endowed with power and prowess, the god's rage-mantra of the three killings, is gathered together. Recite it fiercely, and strike it forth from the heart.

The signs are these: a king and a lord, a man bearing a tiger's gear and banner, and a crowd of men in hats come forward. There will be killing and cutting, the tearing out of hearts, and a heart actually torn out and flung.

When the signs have appeared, take the effigy from the heart. Cut it with a weapon and burn it in fire. Make the ashes into a clay figurine, place it in a skull, and press it down beneath a divine support or the dwelling place of the world's Great God (Śiva). The plague of the gods will fall upon the enemy.

Now the fierce mantra of the Mother Goddesses, the lords of disease. In the skull of a human woman who gave birth to a son, place an effigy within its heart. Seal the mouth with dark blue silk, and bind the skull with five-colored threads. In the center of a dark blue triangular maṇḍala, place the skull and perform the rite. With the heart-blood of three dark-brown black animals, make offerings to the Mother Goddesses together with their retinue. Gather as many of the fierce rite substances as possible: white mustard, black mustard, skye-tshe, and the rest.

The cursing mantra of the Mother Goddesses:

Mama hṛdaya kha rak. Mama hṛdaya kha rak. Mama rakṣa. Mama rak śa. Trak rak śa, to the heart-blood, huba ja. Heart-blood vein, dun dun. Trak rak śa mama ja ja. Nam nam, the enemy's heart, rbad bu nan, mama nṛ-heart, citta, thun. Trak rak śa tra rak śa mo thun thun. Mugs mugs, myogs myogs, rbad rbad, ja ja, mama thun. Heart-blood thun. Śa ti ta mama rak mo. Samaya bhyo bhyo.

This evil mantra of killing, in which the life-essence of the Mother Goddesses is gathered, should be empowered within an iron knife-tube or inside a vulture's feather quill.

Women such as Mātr, Siñ, Mon-mo, Phal-mo, and Byi-mo come in a throng, and great flocks of black birds and black vultures descend. They truly bring flesh and heads. The citta leaps up in actual form, and the signs of death become fully complete. Then drive a stake into the heart and kill. Burn a poison tree in the fire as a burnt offering. Fling the thun-blood at the targeted enemy. Gather the ashes and make the clay figurine. Place it in the center of a charnel ground. By means of epidemic diseases, the target is undone.

Now the fierce mantra of the wrathful planetary spirits. Take the skull of a black mon-pa goat, and place an effigy within its heart. Insert an iron knife-tube into the life-vein. Grind white mustard, black mustard, copper, and iron to powder. Recite the mantra over the thun and scatter it into the skull.

Māra paśa miki. Duru duru. Mati jvala ti ja. Tsa ba mani. Ruru ra hula. Atra tatra padma śara śara śasta. Amuka mura ru phaṭ. Tri liṅka śaṅka dudri. Ja ja

yakṣa thun. Bum dril śini bhaṃ bhava hi. Kha yag kha dun ti. Ruti śuti ti trik śūla prati. Mārāya ja.

This fierce mantra of the mighty planetary spirits should be empowered over fierce substances and struck forth. Make offerings of rotten flesh, rotten blood, cooked food and sacrificial cakes, with three white and three red substances.

The signs: the sun and moon revolve about the head; a black mon-pa comes; great winged serpents coil; the sky is filled with rainbows; the enemy is led forth in person and arrives; vultures and wild animals are killed; and the heart is torn open and played with. When such signs of killing are complete, burn the heart and lungs in a blazing fire, and scatter the thun substances toward the enemy's land. Hide the skull in a dwelling place of the nāgas. Hail and frost are brought down fiercely. Sudden death comes through disease, the target becomes mute, and the limbs stiffen.

Now the fierce mantra of the malignant nāgas. In a secluded place where three valleys meet, draw a dark blue triangular platform. On the head of the enemy's father or grandfather, or else on the skull of a leper, write the enemy's name and bones and place them inside. In a clean vessel, with the three whites, the three sweets, and various nāga medicines, make constant offerings and give commands.

Oṃ Nāgapoṭi tipacaya. Nāgarāja, the enemy he khu la phe śan. Nāga phos phos. Shig shig. Huya huya. Tiya tiya. Tipaca tipaca. Aśa nagpo tipacaya. Nāgarāja, the enemy mārāya rbad. Śakti rbad.

Strike the life! Strike the heart! Strike, strike the pill into the heart! Oṃ Śan Nagpo Pherag Udanāgarājanān. Thilinān. Pholinān.

By speaking this fiercely and accomplishing the rite, there come great blazing fire and great turbulent waters, cattle, oxen, frogs and snakes, gatherings of vows broken and sins, trees felled, the earth split, rocks and crags shattered, and the body suffers peeling skin and leprous sores. With a powerful antidote, subdue the enemy fiercely.

Then, facing north, at a spring, cast out a bali offering and strengthen the truth. Press down the skull together with the ling-ga effigy, and entrust it to the nāga king together with his retinue. Think that the aggregates have been given away without remainder. Having gone back to your place, keep guard. The enemy dies of leprosy and stupor. By the fierce mantras of each of the eight classes, he becomes the executioner of all the malicious Rudras who

afflict the teachings and torment the world through their karma.

Thus the Blessed One declared.

This is the seventh chapter, the chapter on fierce mantras, from the Root Tantra of the Assembly of Fierce Mantras, in which each of the arrogant classes is joined to its own activity.

Then the Vajra Holder explained the individual families, the reasons, the classes, and the actions of the arrogant ones of the world.

In former times, this very world-system, relying on the aggregates and the afflictions, was intoxicated by the power of pride and arrogance. Beings harmed and quarreled with themselves and with all others. Led on by evil dwelling and taking, they answered good with wrongdoing. From the branches of ignorance as the root arose the darkness of delusion: the māras and nāgas. Pride, the arrogance of strength, the master, becomes the gods and kings who go astray. Jealousy goes astray into the families of planetary spirits and Yama's minions. Desire goes astray into the mātṛkās and the yakṣa families. Aversion goes astray into the fierce btsan spirits and the rākṣasas. Because life and body are bound together, it is called māra. The hungry ghosts, Yama's minions, and the rdog spirits roam in subtle ways, appearing arrogant. For that reason the rākṣasas arose.

That by which harm is inflicted is the family and defining mark of a yakṣa. That from which others are produced is the mātṛkā. The one with power to move and agitate is a god. That which is cruel and fierce and cannot be dispelled is called a graha, a planetary spirit. That which is foolish and intoxicated is called a nāga.

Among each of the six classes of beings there are māras, gods, and asuras, yakṣas, planetary spirits and the stars, the classes of gods of the four families of the great kings, the classes of the mātṛkās, rākṣasīs, and humans, the class of Yama's minions and hungry ghosts, while the nāgas are the animal class. The māra family has male and female kinds, some dwelling in their places from the beginning and some arising suddenly. They quarrel, intoxicate, and make arrogant; they create craving and attachment. Yama's minions act through karma and through peace.

Those with form and those without form, those with power and those without power, outer and inner distinctions, were thoroughly shaped by karma: the flesh-eating rākṣasas, those with old women, emanations, those with fierce

bodies, those who roam widely and those who dwell alone. The yakṣas are classified by chief and retinue. The liberated ones and the independent ones are different families, eighteen in number, with the nature of harming and afflicting. Gods belong to the desire realm and the form realm, while the formless belong to the asuras. Because they are exceedingly fierce and rough, they are known as asuras and nonhumans.

That from which things arise, that from which they exist, that which becomes the basis of their production, is known as the mātṛkā. Karma and wisdom are gathered and divided. By the distinction of subtle and gross, they appear as large and small, as principal and retinue. Those with fierce power who move through the sky are nothing but heaps of karma.

Kings, high priests, brahmins, commoners, and outcastes become the twenty-five limbs. The different families are the classes. These are the substance of the original karma. By substance, intrinsic nature, and defining mark, the apprehended and apprehender of confused ignorance arose. The view of self lies dormant as a latent tendency. From subtle movements everything arises, appearing as turmoil, harm, and strife.

Meritorious karma and its opposite, the two extremes of karma, fall into the abyss. Black, nonvirtuous, and defiled, it is the unspecified, the unrighteous, wrongly done through the three of body, speech, and mind.

The dwelling takes on the foulness, and its continuity is joined to it. Together with the three times and the directions, by following along and by turning back, the foundation of saṃsāra is firmly planted. Through ignorance of each particular, they cut off life, seize enjoyments, and do every kind of harm. Splendor, wealth, and whole retinues, whatever there is, they can destroy and ruin, and they bring suffering into the mindstream. The unruly ones work evil: they take life, snatch away longevity, cut down and eat flesh; they bring intoxication, stupor, epidemics, plague, and pestilence; they cause paralysis and send virulent diseases; they inflict curses, turmoil, quarrels, and strife; and through scattering, hexing rites, and imprecations, each from its own class pervades all with eight and eight. With sixty-six limbs included, the varieties of karma are beyond thought.

Of the proud lords, each in particular, by the difference in nature and purpose, those who hold the pledge to guard rightly the teachings of the buddhas of the three times, for the wrathful mantra and the curse of karmic action, with a hundred, with twelve, and with sixteen, with powers, miraculous displays, and

might, whatever is praised in their own class, by applying it to this and that, whatever the end of the action aims at, is fully accomplished by the Vajra-holder. My strength, my power, my might, my miraculous display, and the host of my qualities, whatever one strives for through body, speech, and mind, will manifest in that very thing. Its common accomplishment is fully achieved, and it also brings it to its final end. Therefore, in the future, let not those who are troubled by defilements give rise to doubt. I and all the Victors have praised this highly. Thus he declared.

This is the eighth chapter, the teaching on the divisions of the classes of the proud ones, from the Root Tantra of the Assembly of Wrathful Mantras.

Then the Vajra-holder taught the stages of applying these to action. Charnel grounds, islands in the waters, mountain peaks, places where waters gather, chasms and gorges, terrifying places, ruins, and unruly forests: these are the places of action for the proud ones. Human bones, places where people have been killed, ruined ground, places of dust and ash, places of foul rotting decay, a ripe plot of earth, great filth, unruly blood: these are the substances on which the dependent connection of the action is focused.

Black horse, black bear, buffalo, water buffalo, tiger, and lion; white horse, mongoose, white vulture; black bear, wild horse, and boar; great dragon, peacock, tortoise; bird, dog, cuckoo, owl, and human; banners, skullcups, heart, and blood; nectar, grain essence, and awakening mind; one's own form, the essence together with the wheel, adorned, and whatever corresponds to the remaining substances: these are the offerings and supports of the pledge.

For each mantrin's workplace, a bad skull, black grain, poison, boiled blood, the three ingredients, poison, and weapons are the substances that suit the act of killing. The three bloods of the hex, the three foul odors, the three living creatures, the three hex substances, the three substances of method, the three burnt substances, the three support places, the three places for bells, the three places of dwelling, and the three places of sending down: by the application of exertion in which all are complete, the sending down of the wrathful waters is surely accomplished.

With the families, the vessels, the offering substances, and the purified place, with a mind that has let go of the aspiration for existence as awakening, with good commitment and a harmonious mind, one entrusts the act to whatever one aims at. In the temple that holds the likeness of the dharmakāya, there are the three places above and below and the three lords: the depths of the

ocean, the corner of Mount Meru, the realm of the intermediate space, and the expanse of the sky. The actions of guarding, repelling, and killing, of gathering armies and increasing glory, and of intense wrath may be applied.

By action, one turns back the curses of others. With the evil skull of three nostrils, in eight inauspicious places, by joining together the arising of dependent connection, one suppresses the power and strength of what one has aimed at. In particular, by the variety of actions, kings, nobles, lords and officials, wives, teachers, preceptors, the ordained, householders, mantra practitioners, outsiders, Dharma companions, and the great and powerful, swollen with arrogance and pride...

Those who are proud and of good fortune, honored and praised by all, who have trained their minds and show gratitude over the long term, who stay close to the teachers and abide in study, who are greatly protected by a superior deity, who have obtained the power of shared capacities, and who are gathered together by a single quality: such are the ones difficult to subdue. Those whom all praise, the companions of meditative absorption and visualization, are destroyed by one endowed with excellent mantra and diligence.

Moreover, as taught by the holders of the vajra, myself and others of equal standing, the actions of pacifying, increasing, subjugating, and wrathful activity are carried out with unobstructed power. These are the secret curses, the essential and vital points of each of the eight classes of haughty spirits.

Then follows the mantra of cursing, a long sequence of syllables that I give as they stand: Ya ma du ha na ha na tiṣṭha tiṣṭha rutra mama soda soda. Khatri ja matri ja ja. Shok tri ja. Yakṣa ja. Dhri ja. Shatri patri ja. Citta pramaya amuka sroga la ja ja bhyo. Tri tsa pala ag shug me. Abhisha. Abhishu. Tsakra rakṣa samaya dun thum ril li li. Myag myag myog. Sroga la thun rbad. Rakṣa sroga la phrig phrig. Apatilikiniya ma shri hri sti bhri tri tana kroma ripatra sroga la dun bhyo. Mahā yakṣa thum ril rbad. Maru tse dha sha grib pra maling. By the sounds of killing, cutting, and seizing, all actions come to be accomplished and praised.

Nṛ hur thums ja. Śatruṃ mārāya rbad. Amuka mārāya numaka maru soda soda. This is the curse of slaying and striking.

Then follows a further sequence of syllables, which I give as they stand: Byi sha miki duru mitrika kata jvala ata jala svāhā. Tsapati rāhula mahā krodha kapa shar shar ta sharati hūṃ phaṭ. Bishula duma gisha jvala an. Mahā

tsandha rakṣa hṛda nṛmaya rutra satri byi nāga rātsa bega ananta ragya ti
sandha rakṣina citta bhami kuru. Muhri tsandha dumbu dumbu. Khala rakṣa
thum rili li. Mama samaya tragrakṣa tragrakṣa matrigana. Masa khaya kuru ti
rtse bhali muta dara dara. Trikarmi tri. Dul dul. Snying khrag la ril ril. Rtsa la
thun thun. Trag rag mo hril hril. Shag shag. Shar shar rbad. Mama tsagsha
tragtu phrom. Asela mi byi ru lu ru lu mama tragrakṣa hril hril shar bhyo.
Māraya raṃ hril shar bhyo. Shel tra hūṃ drag tu rtsar shuti phrom kar phrom.
Phyir mati bashad. Migi rirahula shag shag hril phob. Khrag la tsa ra mu sha
bhyo. Trag ram thun shag ril ram shar bhyo. Dūd phrom kar shuti phrom. Nag
hril sen shags дума ya hril bhyo. Pratapa shaya yama snying ya ma snying ya
ma khrag. Rāhula hril hril shag shag. Ser ser. Tug tug. Ya ya. Phob phob.
Mukaye. Kapaye. Apaye. Hrī stī byi krinte. Japati rāhula mahā krota kababta
shar shalta te hūṃ phaṭ. Thig nig. Shuti phrom. Dūd phrom. Mthongs phye.
Lcags sgrog khrol. Mi reng sod. Rkyang rje rkyang mo tsuru tsuru. Ho ho.
Phrom phrom. Mura mura sha. Duru phrom. Thog hūṃ hūṃ soda soda.

Through wind, clouds, and the movements of the planets, and through the
proper measure of directions and signs, one should understand the methods
for bringing down. The wrathful actions of above, below, and between, those of
piercing, scattering, burning, boiling, summoning, hurling, shouting, cursing,
tormenting, torturing, encircling, destroying, cutting, and crushing, bring ruin
to ripening harvests.

Then the mantra: Nagpo tipatsa yan rakṣa. Rāja dhe gulu phesha rakṣa nān.
Phos phos. Shig shig. Huya huya. Tirya tirya. Kāla nāga bandha dgrabo māraya
ja. Nagpo tipatsaya phesha rakṣa ja. Nāga kakala phesha rakṣa ja ja. Ashan
nāga tipatsaya dgrabo mārāya ja. Nāga rāja shakti sroktila rbad. Snying la rol.

Shamshām, phaṭ. Īsān nān. Pheśa rakṣa unān. Nāga nān thili nān. Phili nān.
Tsiri nān. Apar sod rmag. Dul dul kāla dubs myogs thibs. Māraya, gather,
gather. Dhara dhara. Dhuru dhuru. Ruru. Rara. Titi. Trimō titi. Garu gara gtor
dza mareteg. Manja, pheśan rakṣa utānān. Bhashini. Sharle. Shurumule.
Dhatamarena. Huya huya. Rati rati. Thirishag tsagi. Nṛ māra triya madu ya ma,
heart, yam, blood, tsalpa baṃ ril. Nagpo tipa rakṣa nān. Khug rola baṃ.
Enemy, māraya ja. Nagpo tipa tsa. Into the heart, ja. Shagshan nān. Khug
thum ril phaṭ. Tsandri rakṣa rola khug thun kāla, into the heart, thum ril phaṭ.
Kāla śoro, into the heart, trakṣa haraka. Amuka māraya thum ril phaṭ nān.

Summoning, going forth, and the performing of action, when these are
endowed with their own proper signs, should be joined to the action that is

aimed at. Reversal, unaccomplished entanglement, scattering, tormenting, and exhaustion to the very end; the antidote, the removal of the leaf and nose, gathering, transferring, and the inexhaustible treasure. By means of unobstructed enjoyment, one should entrust it to the expanse of the dharmadhātu.

For the eight classes, the mantra of each one's own name, together with the cursing in each one's own language: Deva abhi sarva bhyo, reverse. Pra la dun tse, bring down. Vajra, strike, śo samaya hri bhyo. Basanti maru ru. Yama trig bhūta kṣipa lo hūṃ.

By these fierce mantras of reversal, transformation, and poison, bringing all actions to their end, either I or other vajra-holders like me, through the outer, inner, and secret actions, should apply them to whomever is praised. Others should have no doubt, for I and the buddhas of the three times perceive this directly.

Thus the Blessed One spoke. This is the ninth chapter of the Root Tantra, the Assembly of Fierce Mantras: the chapter on applying actions according to the distinctions of their aims.

Then the Vajra-Holder spoke this praise of qualities.

Hūṃ. From the mandala of play in the great charnel ground, in the blazing celestial palace of fierce wrath, upon a throne of rudra corpses, the destroyers of the malicious, upon a seat of radiant sun, moon, and lotus, there abides the lord of the arrogant, chief of the vajra-holders, the Blessed One, the glorious and powerful Black One. His body is dark blue-black, intensely blazing. The nine grounds perfected, he shows nine heads. His eighteen thousand hands and his feet subdue the four māras in their pride. The central face is dark blue, the right white, the left red, wrathful, laughing, and glaring. His matted hair, black as soot, blazes to the peak of existence. With his eyes he gazes on all the three realms without exception. With his nostrils he inhales all three realms of existence. With his ears and the roar of thunder he fills the three-thousandfold world. With his fangs he liberates all harmful and malicious beings. With his tongue, red lightning, he pervades the world. With wrathful, burning light he gathers all into his power. His head is adorned with the family of enlightened activity.

Of his eighteen hands, the first two hold the vajra and bell that summon and bring under power. In the eight lower hands, on the right and left, are the eight arrogant gods; the bhandha is on the right, and the heart and life-channel are

held on the left. He is adorned with blazing ornaments, and the eight protecting gods are complete in his body. With his right and left feet he crushes the arrogant. He is the slayer of the unruly and those hard to tame, the glory who subdues the Rudras of wrong view.

The mistress of the five elements, the consort of nonduality, has three heads, six hands, and four legs joined in union. In her right hands are a curved knife, a trident, and nectar; in her left are the bhandha, a great field, and the foundation of prosperity. Dark blue-black, she pervades all with her light.

Some are emanations of the family for particular purposes. This one displays three heads, six hands, and four legs. The body is dark blue-black, wrathful and fierce. With the first of the six hands, right and left, he stirs and drinks conch-blood with a vajra. With the other four hands, right and left, he plays with the eight gods and the eight nāgas and with their hearts. The great consort has one face and two hands, her body dark blue-black, her two legs joined in union.

With the right hand he lifts the vast expanse of the sky; with the left he presses down the earth of the world. From the face the five elements blaze forth. From the blessing of the Great Glorious Father and Mother come the emanated arrogant spirits, male and female, with their chief. There is a dark demoness, black, with steaming breath. She has one face and two hands, her body dark blue. In her right hand she holds a staff and a trident; with the left she hurls a khaṭvāṅga and a noose. She wears a garment of fresh flayed skin, and her two feet crush the heart of the malevolent. Another is the black demoness, dripping blood, who holds a staff and a fresh skull-cup in her hands. Her body is clothed in new flayed skin. She rides a black demon horse, and with her feet she grinds the enemies and obstructors to dust.

The black Lord of Death, Yama, has one face and two hands, his body dark black. In his right hand he holds a skull-cup of blood, and in his left a curved knife. His consort, the Great Mother, the Devourer, holds a curved knife and a skull in her hands. Father and Mother both wear fresh flayed skin. They ride an enraged buffalo and a water buffalo, and with their feet they crush the enemies and obstructors, male and female.

The Slayer of Rākṣasas is black in body and holds a sword and a skull-cup of blood. The Great Mother, the Slayer, likewise holds a curved knife and a human skull in her hands. She wears a garment of fresh flayed skin and rides a tiger and a lion at play.

The yakṣa Pūrṇabhadra also has one face and two hands, his body blue. He waves a black silk banner and strikes with flayed skin. The Great Mother, the Flesh-eater, has a single braid; she is an emanation who takes the form of a consort. She wears flayed skin and rides a snow lion.

The great lord of wrathful mantra is the Great Lord, chief of the gods. His color is white; he waves a crystal sword and a banner. He wears a robe of white silk and a great white cloak, and rides a white sky-horned beast. Black Liberation, chief of the Rudras, holds an offering torma and a poison-draft in his hands. He wears flayed skin and rides a black bear.

The black Dmu lord and master wields a black silk banner and a sword. He wears a black cloak and rides a Dmu horse. The non-Buddhist (tīrthika) Kāla Yakṣa, dark blue-black, holds a khaṭvāṅga and a trident. He wears flayed skin and rides a buffalo. Black Viṣṇu holds a staff and a battle-axe in his hands. Clothed in black cloud, he rides a blue dragon.

The nāga king Varuṇa, lord of nāgas, wears a robe of yellow-black serpents and holds a vase and a tortoise in his hands. He rides a nine-headed sea monster. The king named Haramdze is white, holding a crystal sword and white silk. His excellent son, Blazing Red, holds a long spear in his right hand and a butcher's knife in his left. Vajra Beauty, red in color, holds an iron weapon and a battle-axe. Kule, the blazing nine-armed one, is golden, and spreads out nine emanated arms. He wears flayed skin and tramples a corpse.

The lords of wrathful mantra, chief and retinue alike, subdue the retinues of their own families. Their individual emanations are beyond imagining. Those who sever are the hosts of māras; those who cause death are the hosts of Yama; the slayers and butchers are the hosts of rākṣasas; the bearers of savage cruelty are the hosts of yakṣas; those with fierce power are the hosts of gods; those who send sickness and spirits are the hosts of the Mothers; the sovereigns of the sky are the hosts of planets; the dull, mute, and malicious are the hosts of nāgas. These eight classes wield wrathful curses and mantras, and their might and miraculous power are beyond imagining. Their retinues and classes cannot be fully told. They are an inexhaustible treasure of activity and enjoyment, and their qualities and abilities are beyond measure.

To those full of aversion they appear wrathful. To the arrogant they appear superior. To the lustful they appear repulsive. To the deluded they appear intoxicated. Against the miserly they act by seizing. To the jealous they appear terrifying. There is not one you do not tame. Accept the offerings and the

gathered substances of fulfillment. Carry out the tasks entrusted and committed to you. Be pleased by praise and by practice, and perform your activity.

Then their own heart-essence, and the lords of the arrogant spirits of the world.

Apply them to the activities of their respective mantras. The great Vajra-holder, with the intention of awakening mind, abandons all expectation and hope, and, keeping the Buddha's teaching firmly in view, accomplishes the Lord of Wrathful Mantras. Then I and all the buddhas are pleased. One attains the ground of the awareness-holders and becomes a teacher of sentient beings. All the common siddhis, the near ones, and those that lead to the supreme, even those that are distant, arise directly from that hero. One obtains the power of supreme qualities, and practices the conduct of the bodhisattvas, praised above worldly ways, and acts with the strength of the great ones, who realize the great grounds. Proud of power, strength, and capacity, one cannot be overcome by others, and one brings all under one's own sway, so that commands go uncontested. Thus he spoke.

This is the tenth chapter, the chapter on praise and the recitation of qualities, from the Root Tantra of the Gathering of Wrathful Mantras.

Then the Blessed One, the great Vajra-holder, emanated his own body in the manner of the Great Terrifying One. His mind entered the meditative absorption of the great peace of the nature of reality. From all the places of his body he sent forth immeasurable nets of light, which pervaded all the dwellings of the arrogant ones in all the world-realms of the ten directions. Every mind and intention that was unruly, cruel, and fierce was transformed, leaving no remainder, into peaceful awakening mind. Appearing in that region with benefit, happiness, harmlessness, love, and delight, they all paid homage to the Blessed One, that Vajra-holder, and spoke as follows.

Alas, Blessed Vajra-Holder! This great secret teaching of yours, in times to come, will spread and flourish. We, the arrogant ones of the world, having been established in a peaceful mind, will follow it, and what we practice we will expand for benefit. Through our activity, view, and conduct, which pervade everything, we will bring it to complete perfection. Like companions, servants, and common folk, we will do whatever we are commanded. To those who guard the sacred commitments and possess the virtues and the playful absorptions, we will not stray from your word, and we will gladly accomplish

what you have spoken. Blessed Vajra-Holder, whatever tasks you have assigned, we will swiftly accomplish with our strength. Make your blessing the chief support.

Having spoken thus, they vanished and departed to their own abodes. The Blessed One gathered the arrays of light rays, and all the appearances of his own retinue, into the expanse of his own body, and caused the body itself to abide in the nature of the dharmakāya.

This is the eleventh chapter, the chapter on entrusting the activities, from the Root Tantra of the Gathering of Wrathful Mantras.

The Vajra Root Tantra of the Gathering of Wrathful Mantras is complete.

It was translated, revised, and finalized by the great Indian preceptor, the master Padmasambhava, and the Tibetan translator Vairocana. It derives from a copy made from the personal manuscript of King Trisong Detsen.

Translator's Notes

- The opening fragment belongs to the preceding text's colophon. The Sanskrit title transliteration is rendered as given and appears corrupt (Bhirusanti, Mara). Several proper names are uncertain: Langpel Gyi Senge, presumably the disciple Langdro-type name; Red Yamśud; the Mu king; and "Hand-Wanderer." The place name "of willow leaves" is a literal rendering. The identification of འཇིགས་པའི་ལྷ་མོ་ as Īśvara (Śiva) is the standard reading. The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end.
- This passage is a dense, partly corrupt wrathful-deity description. The opening line is unclear; "the great chief of the Pratyekas" renders the reading as it stands, though the original sense may be a different figure. Several terms are left as transliterated: "bhandha" is an unclear term (possibly a skull-cup or implement) and is kept untranslated; "citta" likewise. "Mu-rje" is an unidentified class of beings, left as it appears. The seed syllable and the mantras are given in approximate Sanskrit reconstruction; several of the mantra syllables are corrupt, so the transliteration is conjectural. The lines about the mistress of the great elements and her implements are especially obscure.
- The Sanskrit mantra at the opening is transliterated from the Tibetan and is corrupt in places (Nāgarāja, Kumāra, Caṇḍa and Yamāraya seem recognizable, the rest is opaque), so I have kept it close to the Tibetan letters. Several proper names in the verses are transliterations I could not reliably identify (Rmuje, Libi, Thesé, Yamshu, and "Black Liberator"), and I have given them in approximate form. The line about the māra king's mount, riding a black horse "bear and lion at once" (khyo shug), is obscure in the Tibetan; khyo shug may be a term for a married pair, so it may mean the couple rode together, and I have not resolved this. The identification of Rokti as Viṣṇu follows the Tibetan epithet "Khyab 'jug." The mention of "Pūrṇabhadra" for gang ba bzang po is the standard equivalence.
- Several class-names of spirits in the long list (gongpo, thé, ging, mu, gyendren, men, Thorshong, Chedrak, Tsal, Duntip, Tongtrug, Lenzhing) are transliterated because their identification is uncertain. The phrase "chieftains of the hunt" follows a probable reading of the Tibetan; it may instead denote chieftains of pursuit or retinue. The line about the crude surface

of wisdom is a tentative reading of a difficult Tibetan phrase. The chapter colophon is kept in the body as part of the text's structure.

- The verses are dense with tantric technical terms, and the rites of liberation (sgrol ba) are rendered in the standard way. The final lines, on the substance of awakening mind and the "fire-frog," are obscure and may reflect an anatomical or ritual image. Some terms (Rudra, liṅga, the nine modes of conduct) are kept literal without a gloss.
- Several lines in the list of substances contain obscure names of ritual materials, evidently transliterated or technical terms (giling, srid shing, tsa ra ka, tira, bhandha, rakta). I rendered them as transliterations or literally rather than guess at identifications. The identity of the wood-names (seng ldeng, gser shing) is also uncertain. The phrase "three supports" (rten gsum) is taken as the supports of body, speech, and mind. "The haughty ones" translates dregs pa, the proud or arrogant class of wrathful spirits and deities, here used for the deities of the maṇḍala.
- This passage is a wrathful tantric rite of cursing, with several obscure Tibetan terms rendered conservatively or left untranslated: kakamala, gings, btsan, 'gong, rmu, skye-tshe, shang-tshe, ngar, mu-su-ra, rabs beer, and the "life-force mark" (srog tig). Several lines are corrupt or ambiguous, notably "the closing of the pit," "the planet's cry," and "mighty hail" (possibly "mighty force"). The mantra syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan as given and are partly garbled.
- The passage is a violent ritual text with many obscure transliterated mantric syllables, rendered phonetically rather than translated; several lines (the ritual substances, "Mon," "ngar") are sometimes uncertain. I have rendered the grammatically clear Tibetan lines and left the unintelligible syllables as mantra. The phrase "□□□□□" appears twice in the opening verse, as in the source.
- This is a destructive-rite (abhicāra) passage, and the mantras are partly corrupt or non-Sanskritic; I have transliterated them rather than translated. Several obscure terms are left as transliterations: skye-tshe, "thun" (a ritual substance or effigy-offering), "rbad," and the women's names Siñ, Mon-mo, Phal-mo and Byi-mo. "Citta" in the vulture passage may be a proper ritual term for the effigy or the victim's mind-essence; I left it untranslated. □□□□□ (liṅga) is rendered "effigy," following its usage in destructive rites.
- The first mantra and the verse about the eight classes are given in transliteration since the syllables are not translatable. The "pill" in the first line renders ril, a ritual object, probably a bolus or effigy-pellet. The phrase about bringing to a place and guarding follows the sense of the Tibetan but its ritual referent is not fully clear. The "ling-ga" is the ritual effigy, left as a transliteration. The line on "those with old women" (rgan mo can) is obscure and rendered literally. The Tibetan text ends abruptly mid-sentence in the final stanza, and the translation stops where the Tibetan does.
- The passage begins mid-verse and ends mid-sentence, so the opening and closing lines are fragmentary. The line about "the three nostrils" of the evil skull, the lists of "three" substances and places, and the phrase "eight and eight" are cryptic ritual terms whose exact referents are uncertain; I rendered them literally. The line "with a mind that has let go of the aspiration for existence as awakening" is tentative and may have a more specific tantric sense. The word translated "proud ones" (drekpa) denotes the arrogant, haughty spirits of the wrathful tradition.
- The mantric syllables are corrupt and partly untranslatable. I have transliterated them in simplified phonetic form rather than reconstructing Sanskrit, since many are Tibetan-inflected or garbled. The opening verses describe those who are difficult to subdue, and I take the grammar as describing the proud and fortunate persons from the preceding list. The line about the sounds of killing, cutting, and seizing is a probable reading of a difficult couplet. The line "mthongs phyé" and the final syllables are left as sounds. Tibetan terms in the mantra, such as snying (heart) and khrag (blood), are preserved as sounds, though their meanings are evident.

- The opening mantra section is largely corrupt, with transliterated syllables mixed with Tibetan words (heart, blood, enemy, gather); I transliterated what was phonetic and translated the Tibetan words. The lines on the method terms (unaccomplished entanglement, removal of the leaf and nose, and so on) are obscure technical shorthand for ritual procedures and are rendered literally. Several attributes in the iconography (bhandha, the great field, foundation of prosperity, the ṣaṭ-hand implements) are uncertain in exact referent, so I kept the transliterations or the literal sense. The Black One is Nagpo, a wrathful form of Vajrapāṇi in this tradition.
- This passage is a litany of wrathful deities, and several names are uncertain in my rendering. I took "Great God" lords as in the continuity, but the passage's own divine names are glossed as follows: "Yama" for the Lord of Death, "Pūrṇabhadra" for gnod sbyin gang ba bzang po, "the Great Lord" for dbang phyug chen po (Maheśvara, i.e. Śiva), "Varuṇa" for klu rgyal ba ru ṇa. Several figures (Haramdze, Kule, Dmu, Black Liberation) are transliterated or literally rendered because their identifications are unclear. The Tibetan "zhing lpags" (flayed skin) and "gnam ru" (sky-horned beast) are rendered literally. The passage ends mid-sentence, continuing in the next section.
- The opening line is mid-sentence, and its antecedent is in the preceding passage; I read "apply them to the activities of their respective mantras" as continuing the previous instruction. "The great Vajra-holder" is taken as the speaker in the verse, with "that hero" a reference to the accomplished practitioner. The line "Make your blessing the chief support" renders a petition for the Vajra-holder's empowering grace to be the foremost aid. "The Great Terrifying One" translates the name of the wrathful form (Mahābhairava or Mahābhayaṅkara type epithet); I have kept it descriptive rather than commit to a Sanskrit reconstruction.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.